

PART A. Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Problem

As children attend school every day, they are met with a dull environment that may be detrimental to their moods, and therefore, their quality of education. The task of this project is to design and complete a colorful mural with a positive message that will improve students' mindsets across all four Elementary-Middle Schools in Buchanan County. Buchanan County Schools' Nutritional Supervisor, commissioned students Erin Faulkner and Hannah Baker to design and execute a portfolio that promotes healthy eating habits and reflects school spirit in each school's cafeteria.

Justification

According to the Mental Health Foundation, one in every nine children suffers from a mental health disorder. For many, schools provide a safe space where struggling children can find community and routine. However, schools are often empty and drab, with plain beige walls and little color, which negatively affects students' moods. Murals are an affordable and simple solution to these problems, contributing to the creation of a colorful, positive learning environment.

Murals frequently display a message to their audience. Often, children do not have a consistent idea of diets with true nutritional value. By designing a mural that communicates healthy eating habits, students' physical health will be improved as well as their mental health. According to Second Harvest of Silicon Valley, an improved diet often directly correlates with improved grades. Promoting a healthy diet, particularly in the school cafeteria, in a bright and colorful way, will not only improve students' mental and emotional health but also their physical health and grades.

Citations

Mental Health Foundation. "Children and Young People: Mental Health Statistics." *Mental Health Foundation*, 2022, www.mentalhealth.org.uk/.

Second Harvest of Silicon Valley. "Top 6 Reasons Healthy Food Is Important for Students in School." *Second Harvest of Silicon Valley*, 18 Nov. 2023, www.shfb.org/impact/blog/top-6-reasons-healthy-food-is-important-for-students-in-school/.